



FREE GUIDE · FOR ENDOSCOPY & GI CENTERS

The Endoscopy / GI Center's Guide to Compliant Disposal.

Sedation controls, biopsy waste, and scope
disinfectants — every stream, handled right.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

Sedation and scope chemicals.

Endoscopy and GI centers combine procedural sedation — controlled substances the DEA watches — with biopsy sharps and biohazard, and the high-level disinfectants used to reprocess scopes, some of which are hazardous chemicals. This guide covers every stream and the ones (like scope disinfectant) that are easy to overlook.

The good news

One DEA-registered vendor can take your sedation controls, sharps, and biohazard — and help you handle scope-reprocessing chemicals — with a Certificate of Destruction and no contract.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training.
EPA	RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.
DEA	Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.
DOT	Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.
State	Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Controlled substances

Procedural sedation — fentanyl, midazolam — expired and wasted.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired / unused Schedule II–V sedatives
- Wasted & partial sedation doses
- Surrendered controlled stock

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-controlled meds (pharmaceutical kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · DEA — render non-retrievable, complete a DEA Form 41 for surrendered controls, keep witnessed waste logs.

DISPOSE WITH · Controlled-substance / medication mail-back kit, to DEA standards.

Tip

Log and witness every wasted controlled dose — the DEA checks the paper trail.

WASTE STREAM 02

Sharps

Biopsy, injection, and procedure sharps.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Biopsy & procedure needles
- Injection sharps
- Syringes

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Bloody gauze (biohazard)
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)
- Non-sharp packaging

THE RULE · OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers, no overfilling, annual training.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit.

Tip

Replace containers at the fill line; keep them upright, closable, and out of reach.

WASTE STREAM 03

Biohazard / regulated medical waste

Biopsy tissue and procedure biohazard.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Biopsy specimens & tissue (per state)
- Blood-soaked materials
- Contaminated PPE

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Sharps (sharps kit)
- Lightly soiled everyday items
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)

THE RULE · OSHA plus your state's medical-waste rules — red bags, labeling, treatment/destruction, retained documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Biohazard mail-back kit.

Tip

Only visibly blood/OPIM-contaminated items are red-bag waste — check your state's definition.

WASTE STREAM 04

Scope-reprocessing chemicals

Easy to overlook — high-level disinfectants like glutaraldehyde and OPA can be hazardous chemical waste.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Spent glutaraldehyde / OPA
- Other hazardous reprocessing chemicals
- Characteristic hazardous waste

DOES NOT GO HERE

- General cleaning products
- Sharps
- Biopsy tissue

THE RULE · EPA and state rules — spent high-level disinfectants may be regulated as hazardous chemical waste; confirm your product's requirements.

DISPOSE WITH · RCRA-hazardous handling — we'll help you scope it.

Tip

Check your disinfectant's SDS — some formulations require hazardous-waste disposal, not the drain.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The endoscopy / GI compliance checklist.

- ☐ Sedation controls logged, wasted doses witnessed, non-retrievable with Form 41.
- ☐ Biopsy and procedure sharps in FDA-cleared containers.

- ☐ Biopsy tissue and biohazard handled per state rules.
- ☐ Spent scope disinfectants (glutaraldehyde/OPA) checked against SDS and handled correctly.
- ☐ Staff trained annually on OSHA bloodborne pathogens.
- ☐ Certificates of Destruction retained per your state's rules.

QUESTIONS GI CENTERS ASK

Your endoscopy center questions, answered.

How do we handle wasted sedation drugs like fentanyl or midazolam?

Witness and log every wasted dose, then render it non-retrievable with a DEA Form 41 and keep the wasting log.

Do we need special disposal for scope disinfectants?

Sometimes — spent glutaraldehyde or OPA can be hazardous chemical waste depending on the product and your state. Check the SDS; we'll help you scope it.

Is biopsy tissue regulated?

Yes — it's regulated medical waste; tissue rules vary by state.

Do we need a contract?

No — no contract, no minimums.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle ships prepaid mail-back kits (or scheduled pickup for volume) sized to an endoscopy/GI center — sedation controls, sharps, and biohazard — with Form 41 handled and a Certificate of Destruction, plus guidance on scope-reprocessing chemicals. No contract.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Sedation controls	Controlled destruction (Form 41, wasting logs)
Biopsy & procedure sharps	Sharps mail-back kit
Biopsy tissue biohazard	Biohazard mail-back kit

Waste stream

The right path

Scope disinfectants (if hazardous)

RCRA-hazardous handling

Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

Higher-volume GI centers often prefer scheduled pickup — we'll size a program. Get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.

WHY ENDOSCOPY & GI CENTERS CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order

Ready to simplify your endoscopy center waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop